

Medical Debt Calculator

Final Enhanced Specification (v4)

Core Defaults

Total Debt	\$250,000
Interest Rate	6.5%
Loan Type	Federal
Residency Length	3–7+ years
Residency Salary	\$65,000 (2% annual growth)
Attending Salary	\$250,000 (3% annual growth)
PSLF Status	OFF by default

Key Corrections & Realism Fixes

- PSLF forgiveness is not guaranteed tax-free under all future policy scenarios; depends on current law.
- Residency years count toward PSLF only if employment qualifies under federal rules.
- Standard repayment assumes a 10-year term starting after training or equivalent consolidation structure.
- Unpaid interest may capitalize depending on loan type and repayment plan selection.
- Interest accrual during residency significantly affects long-term payoff.

Expanded Specialty Salary Presets

Specialty	Salary	Training Duration
Primary Care	\$220,000	3 years
Internal Medicine	\$240,000	3 years
Pediatrics	\$210,000	3 years
Family Medicine	\$215,000	3 years
Emergency Medicine	\$350,000	3–4 years
Psychiatry	\$280,000	4 years

Specialty	Salary	Training Duration
Anesthesiology	\$400,000	4 years
Radiology	\$420,000	5 years
Pathology	\$300,000	4 years
Neurology	\$300,000	4 years
General Surgery	\$450,000	5–7 years
Cardiology	\$500,000	6–8 years total
Gastroenterology	\$550,000	6–7 years total
Dermatology	\$500,000	4 years
Orthopedics	\$550,000	5 years
Neurosurgery	\$700,000	7 years

Residency & Career Timeline Engine

A major upgrade focusing on the timeline between training and full attending compensation.

- **Repayment Delay:** Residency delays the high-income repayment phase.
- **Interest Accrual:** Interest continues to accrue throughout the entire training period.
- **Fellowship Modeling:** Periods modeled as extended low-income phases.
- **Variable Impact:** Training length directly impacts total interest paid, payoff duration, and net worth trajectory.

Advanced Financial Model Improvements

1. Split Modeling System

Cash Flow Model	Income, Taxes, Savings rate, Lifestyle spending
Debt Model	Interest accrual, Payment allocation, Capitalization events, Forgiveness tracking

2. Additional Features

- **Tax Rate Slider:** (25–40%) impacts real disposable income.
- **Inflation Mode:** Salary adjustment based on CPI (~2–3%).
- **Opportunity Cost:** Calculation of "Investing instead of extra payments = \$X potential wealth".
- **Net Worth Crossover:** Tracking the moment debt turns into positive net worth.

PSLF Logic (Refined & Realistic)

- Requires **120 qualifying payments** (~10 years).
- Residency may count ONLY if employer qualifies.
- Must be on an income-driven repayment plan.
- **Outputs:** Total paid, Amount forgiven, and Net savings vs standard repayment.

Product Features & UX

Interface	Two-column dashboard (Inputs left, Charts right)
Responsiveness	Mobile-first stacked layout
Scenario Presets	Aggressive Payoff, PSLF-Optimized, Minimum Payment
Visuals	

Loan Balance line charts, Net Worth line charts, PSLF vs
Standard bar charts

Disclaimer: This tool is for informational and educational purposes only. All salary figures, repayment assumptions, and financial projections are generalized estimates and may not reflect individual circumstances. Actual physician income, tax rates, loan terms, and repayment outcomes vary significantly. This tool does not constitute financial, tax, or legal advice.